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From the Chief Editor's Desk



The tradition of agamic encryption , -the three goddesses called hunger,thirst ,jealousy and cogitation .

The experience of a perpetual seat in the essential nature versus the incessant effort relates to the arena joining शाक्त and शांभव tactics . Such double entendre's serve a duel purpose firstly to make things sound interesting to the intimated ones and secondly to obscure them from dilettante and dabbler . Having one self defamed was yet another obscurantist tactics . There is a youthful ascetic nun between Ganga and Yamuna she must be taken by force in order to attain the absolute abode of Vishnu . Here hunger, thirst malice and cogitation are encrypted as tactics of Salvation in some antique canons on mysticism this encryption and codifying has been done through disheveled spellings or deranged order of phrases or the tactics of छुम्मक *. These are are esoteric nomenclatures to facilitate secrecy and privacy .presumably meant to prevent a meddler from having access to the agamic mystery arbitrarily I.e. without the discipline of a master . Most of them bear semblance to the main procedure of tantrik practice ,a piece of camphor for example is called a digit of moon, panchamor. Dwitiya is a piece of ginger or radish Karanam- lit. the primordial causation is liquor so forth and so on .

Their actual reference has to be learnt esoterically and their is very little room for etymological or lexicographic justification . Agama and tradition needs no further elaboration so here too hunger is not the impulse that accounts for the process of eating but the process of dissolution or संहार . विश्वघस्मरमहच्चिदोत्कटम् । the enhanced upsurge of subjective consciousness is like a famished entity who would engulf the entire objective phenomena . अन्ताचराचर ग्रहणात् says the Brahm- Sutras referring to dissolution the semiotics of a famished entity who can engulf all sentient as well insentient entities .

The Vedic discipline needs a prerequisite of considerable moral and ethical refinement where as the agamic path begins with the actual disposition of the aspirant I.e. within the quagmire of their lower nature . The aspirant begins with lust ,anger ,greed ,delusion ,vanity

Malice vice and virtues and not with subliminal utopian higher rungs of moral perfection hence the analogy hunger thirst malice and reflection . Hunger is innate and primeval instinct **क्षुत्तिपासेअन्वावर्तेते** say one of the principal Upanishads hunger and thirst prevailed .the consequent procreation generates malice and avarice **स तंव्यौषत्**

द्वितीयाद्वैभयंभवति कस्मन्नुविभेमीति these three primordial instincts along with the means of their sublimation have been discovered by Adept Vatulnath.

. These are comparable to functions of creation ,maintenance annihilation and the great dissolution . These are overcome by the four processes of effort ,mystic, experience,, absorption and complete assimilation (**उद्योग आभास चर्वण अलंग्रास**) these again are the semiotic depictions of tantrik phenomena the last two for instance literally mean chewing and devouring -euphoric way of adding agreeability to terse mysticism . By going beyond these virtual “means “or karmas one identifies his perpetual seat consciousness nature which is incessant **निरवकाशः** I.e. there is no recess for getting stuck in the mire of objectivity and then struggling to seek deliverance from it .this fifth state is only from a empirical stand point and is not with respect to the preceding four . Since This lineage of mysticism pertains to word transcendence it is better propagated by inducing the mystic experience instead of discursive exposition . Both the aphoristic as Well as Hermeneutic texts need to be born in the mind while pursuing on these lines .

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Wisdom from Shiva's Rattle Drum(VIII)

Paranand Swami

॥ झभं॥ ८॥

वाक्पाणी च झभजासीद्विराडूपचिदात्मनः।

सर्वजन्तुषु विज्ञेयं स्थावरादौ न विद्यते॥

वर्गाणां तुर्यवर्णा ये कर्मेन्द्रियमया हि ते॥ १९

Key words

Karmendriya, Virat, sthavara , stress and strains , semantics, limbic movements and human brain , rungs of human evolution and gradations of advancement , sentience without locomotion - the law of karmas .

Speech and feet of the macrocosmic manifestation of the conscious principle emanated from the two consonants **झ** and **भ** I.e. from the eighth beat of the prods rattle drum .

The fourth stressed consonant of each phonetic group.

There is concept of a universal being in the ancient cannons called vaishwanara. The macrocosmic manifestation is an exact replica. Of the microcosmic being and vice versa . Both are identical and homomorphic .An anthropomorphic personification of the universe

Has all the organs and limbs and organs as an individual person has both are perpetually in synchrony . Limbs or organs of action of the Virat or the universal being named as chidatma by nandikeshwara originate from the eighth and ninth aphorism which are the phonetic depictions of shivas rattle drum beats. This sutra however describes only hands and feet of the microcosmic and macrocosmic manifestation of the absolute principle . There are two theories of the origin of creation One propounds the power and. Process from the perspective of the predominance of word or meaning where as the other one establishes meaning as a priori of

word . Bhavabhuti the author of uttaramcharit attributes the word first theory to the Vedic revelations and the meaning first theory to classic Sanskrit .

The eternal word is in perfect harmony with its meaning in the. Transcendental or para mode of manifestation of vak . As the expression gets grosser and consolidate word begins to deviate from the meaning until it is completely separate in the grossest audible speech called vaikhari . This is how a theist produces his counter argument ,to a skeptics interjection that if word and meaning are innately related then why doesn't the mouth burn as you pronounce "Agni ". Nandikeshwara being a spiritual disciple of lord shiva seems to have predated the conceptualisation which evolved later on and developed by and by . His main focus was on the material manifestation of the eternal beats of the rattle drum or the aphorisms into various ontological categorisation of the universe . Like the theory of an a priori of word or let us say eternal word pertaining to the revelations ,Nandikeshwara who maintains that the eternal beats and thus the Sutras of maheshwara predate the material gross manifestation . A recent theory of development of a foetus says that since the time of impregnation a foetus undergoes the entire process of organic evolution from a unicellular Protozoa to a fully evolved homo sepiansepian who is on the highest rung in ladder of organic ,psychological and genetic evolution .genetic because the effect of genetic evolution is most conspicuous in the case of a man as he switches over from nomadic to agrarian or rural and from rural to urbanised mode of living . With the advancement of drawing aboriginal painting in the cave scripting and encrypting has been yet another vista of mans genetic evolution . A kid who develops writing reading and figure recognition cognitive patterns belongs to an entirely clone of humans who are developing genetically at a an accelerated race .The evolution as one of the recent theories go is genetic and the changes caused by the evolution are of psycho and neurological type . It is not just like giraffes stretching their necks to reach leaves on high trees and their kids have elongated necks .the phenomena is more like a play school kid solving complex calculus problems with a computer and his offspring's in turn evolve genetically into what we know these days as indigo babies . neurological, cerebral as well psychological evolution . The two and labial consonents are some sounds one creates during pronounciation only to. Vanish the very next moment ,these are eternally resonate in the chidakash or the ether of consciousness which consolidate to manifest as various parts of the cosmic being . As an individual undergoes the process of prenatal and post natal development the process in fact evolving of an individual into the stature of the cosmic being .

विश्वं विराट् रूपेण पश्येद्भेद निवृत्तये pasted bhednivrittaye . One should meditate upon vishvam or the gross manifestation of an individual soul as one with Virat or the universal being . This. Meditation based on the mantras of mandukya upanishad is not merely fixing the mind but becoming aware of something that is per se . From a philosophic stand point one might as well conclude that this eight beat of maheshwara became gross and manifested as ha Das Anne feet of the cosmic being and thus the microcosmic one as well . Delivering his votaries from the shackles of anthropocentric conditioning nandikeshwara enunciates sarvjantusu ,all sentient creatures. This is from a futuristic stand point since all sentient being are spontaneously evolving into the stature of the cosmic being . There is another theory of this manifestation which also fits. Into this co text Agni e termed the mouth in the form of vak, Indra entered the hands so on and so forth .There is a presiding deity for each sense of knowledge and action but both cosmic presiding deities and. Individual senses are required to be in perfect synchrony for a flaw. Less and exact perception . Even from this view point an individual. Cannot he isolate from the cosmic being . These two syllables do not as it were pervade the cosmic and individual being successively but concomitantly .All rites and rituals aim at restoring this synchrony . Phoenetic and material manifestations and their relevance there are many instances of "the word. Of mouth coming true "even in a worldly parlance . From the organelles of an amoeba upto a chimp who is typing othello on a computer key board and from this penta digital hand who is no more dependent on his hoofs and claws jaws or snouts for survival there has been billions of eons . grasping skill lead the cave man to make stone tools for hunting gathering .each race of human kind developed hundreds of skills with the manipulation of their ten digits . Before the advancement of typewriting and calculators dit -dahs of morse conveyed everything now the arena of what can be done with fingers is immensely broad . Massive amount of data can be dispatched with a single click of a mouse or just a touch on the screen . The faculty of **आदानम्** which with its reciprocating

divergence has become myriad and is still expending in perpetuity says one of the axioms from the Upanishads culminates into the hand . **सार्वेषामादातव्यानां हस्तावेकायतनम्** | in the same manner all expression converge into **वाक् सर्वेषां वक्तव्यानां वागेवेकायतनम्** | the concept of vak in the Veda is the process of expansion of the eternal word into grosser alphabet and then as one hymn from the rikveda goes into

monosyllabic ,bisyllabic, trisyllabic ,quatro syllabic ,octasyllabic and nonasyllabic , and finally expressions with thousand syllables all this happens in the causal ether . *

The gaga gugoo and monosyllabic expressions of islander tribals has evolved into highly sophisticated strings equations and langragians to latest computer language . The impetus of divergence is as forceful as the implosive power of convergent withdrawal . All expression and gestures plus whatever a well evolved and sophisticate man can do with his hands and ten digits converge into the eighth beat of shivas rattle drum . These two beats if pronounced require a mediocre stress of the dental and lip consonant . Owing to their divine and supramundane origin and thus their eternity -the meaning must be a posteriori . This accounts for their mystic interpretation . One must bear in mind that these two syllables and for that matter other four syllables in the next aphorism do not generate speech hand, feet anus and genitalia . These six primeval sounds of the lords rattle drum manifested in the form of cosmic speech etc, which according to some thinkers who are subservient to the Vedas ,are Agni ,Indra , Vishnu,Yama and Prajapathi . In the microcosmic manifestation these deities are called the presiding deities of the organs and are responsible for their respective perceptions .

As per the theory that the process of organic evolution is repeated evolution from womb to tomb who d which only the laws of spiritual evolution of the soul hold good ,the faculty of expression must also have the same pace I.e. from a toddlers gaga googol to a virtuosos stupendous feat of eloquence. The evolution of mudras as in synchrony with expression is as one canon on sanskrit poetics says to infuse emphatically the import of an expression **वाक्येसाभिप्रायनिवेशनम्** . This rapport relates the two most cardinal faculty of human civilisation with another ,speech and gesticulation or what ever a human being can do with two hands and ten finger . Gesticulation as an aid to expression in the case of impaired speech or as assertive emphasis in dramaturgy and poetry has been making speech and hand as complimentary since the beginning of human civilisation .various linguistic theories can be said to be interlaced in this aphorism . Besides the three and six testimonies of evidence in the eastern metaphysics some thinkers have also added

ऐतिह्यं general belief from legends and anecdotes ,**चेष्टितम्** or body language .these however are most relevant in the parlance of dramaturgy and tantric rites where mudra are essential .

Monosyllabic and Dong Dong theories may be traced back to this aphorism provided one is gullible enough to believe that the actual process of pronunciation began with two gradations of deliberate effort after the innate guttural **क** group evolved into **च** the dentals and the mild and strong effort of the breath or prana used in pronouncing these **छ** and **झ** . The idea behind the deranged order has been discussed in our preceding essay ,**यथाप्रयोजनं न तु यथाक्रमम्** |the order is oriented to befit the grammatical process of deriving certain words and to avoid certain aberration if they were to be placed as per the phoenetic order .thus these two bisyllabic and trisyllabic aphorisms precede the one with milder effort and strong effort and the first consonants of the first and second group of consonants. The mystic decoding of Nandikeshwara refers to the order ,power and process of evolution of the universe -from a microcosmic as well microcosmic stand point . So the five perception emanating from the beat we have discussed in the preceding essay become grosser for example sound becomes vak . There is a discussion in the shiv Dristi of soma and 's shiv Drishti regarding what's so special about vak .there are other four organs of action and sense perceptions

“this hand of mine is god even more divine

अयं मे हस्तो भगवानयं मे भगवत्तरः : (ऋग्वेद) ”

Hand and the limb movement of grasping seem to be related to one of the first axioms of human ethics -thou shall not steal ! The ancient Hindu ethical canons call it **अदत्तानामुपादानम्** . Holding with your hands what doesn't come to you rightfully or has not been given to you consentingly . In Buddhist precepts and initiate has to pledge

अदित्रदानाद्वैरमणीं सिखापदं समादयामि ।

I refrain from taking what has not been given to me . After the caveman learnt to do thousand and one things with his fingers most of the evolution organic as well psychological and genetic came to be focused on human hand . Nowhere else in the human civilisation the hands are so much felicitated one recent Manuel on a Hindus daily routine ordains them to look at there hands first thing in the morning . The deity of riches resides on the tip of one's hands , the goddess of learning in the palm of the hand ,god the creator is seated in the heel of one's palm so as soon one rises from sleep one must see his own hand with due reverence .

कराग्रेवसतेक्ष्मी करमध्ये सरस्वती करमूले

स्थितोब्रह्मा प्रभातेकरदर्शनम्।

fully evolved out of his hunter gatherer plight as the primeval human being became agrarian and then rural and urban the ethics as it were manifested and developed spontaneously . The authenticity and contemporaneity of the ethics has been frequently refuted by so called neo spiritualists but from a more impartial and deep metaphysical insight their consistency can not be questioned but their relevance and contextual application needs to come from the horses mouth and not from the holy books and their orthodox interpretation straightaway. The third periphery of the mystic instrument called shrichakram which is a diagrammatic depiction of the universal phenomena , is drawn as an eight petal lotus with goddesses of speech ,grasping ,locomotion ,excretion, pleasure ,rejection ,selection,and indifference . These are various manifestations of the goddesses of consciousness or **चिच्छक्तिः** which are responsible for these eight functions. In the esoteric canons of shrividya these have been mentioned as cognitive function **बुद्ध्यः**:

Shri chakra a diagrammatic encryption of the cosmic phenomena *

As the Vedic theory of spiritual evolution has its sentience in the flora can be explained by the law of karma governing their semi sentience disposition other relevant concepts from the Hindu ethics .

वाचिकैपशुपक्षिताम्

कायिकैस्थावरांतेषु

मानसैरन्त्यजातिताम्

Verbal transgressions degenerate a soul to the level of beasts and birds where as sins of the body degenerate a soul to the level of semi sentient and immovable plants ,herbs and shrubs .

All herbs and shrubs are in fact creatures who have paying for their “sins of the body” so till they are delivered their evolution is impeded

The commentator says that this doesn't hold good in the case of immovable entities like trees herbs and shrubs . The Vedic philosophy maintains that they are semi sentient notwithstanding also have a soul or jiva . jiva being transmigratory is subject to the incessant cycle of deaths and births so all trees and other flora have also been born into various families and species . The impetus of karmas good or bad accounts for their disposition in the rung of spiritual evolution ,the anathema of their demerits has deprived them from these two cardinal faculties of human kind and other creatures . As we have already said earlier the course of organic evolution of an ameba to fully evolved human being is repeated from a zygote to a

fully evolved Homo sapiens . The semi sentient plight of the jiva or empirical soul goes back to the realm of plants ,herbs and shrubs . All other beings even unicellular amoeba exhibit the tendency to grasp and communicate I.e. hand and speech through their “organelles “ or modifications of their cell walls . Hence the postulation **सर्व जंतुषु विज्ञेयं स्थावकादौ न विद्यते ।**

AdiShankara in his commentary on the kathipanisad has warned against unethical unrestricted and **unethical endeavours they will lead you to the degenerate plight of subhuman entities down to semi-sentient flora .

The two beats and the consequent four beats comprise the collective faculty of the organs of actions . What Nandikeshwara seems to be indicating is that since the word is primeval and eternal it not only accounts for the power and process of creation but also pervades the microcosm and macrocosm as the agency of respective functions of their various organs .

***वचनादानगमनविसर्गनिंदहानोपादानउपेक्षा बुद्धयः**

**** कामचारवादभक्षणातिर्यगादिस्थावरांतेषु कथाधोगतिरुक्ता** (Adi shankar’s commentary on kathopanishat)

***ŚrīVidyā* Mantra- A Guide to unravel Cosmic Relationality**

Niraj Kumar

The visible world is not the absolute reality. The reality is relative to an observer. For a human being, the world of sound can only be experienced between the level of 20 Hz to 20,000 Hz. But, for a bat it will be a different sonic universe. Recent explorations in higher sciences have led to the formulation of the idea of multiverse and nested hierarchy. Theoretically, there are infinite worlds plausible apart from our world that we inhabit. NASA estimate suggest that only 5% of the universe is the visible matter, over 27% dark matter and remaining dark energy whose properties remain elusive to the astrophysicist. There are visible and invisible spaces and things both outside and inside our bodies. The universe appears to be graded existence with sheaths which can be tunicated as grosser or subtler depending upon the perspective of the observer. It is akin to cognitive relativism. *ŚrīVidyā* is the most refined conception of establishing relationality between various sheaths of existence. In fact, this science structurally correlates microcosm and macrocosm, human body, cosmic body and geo-body. Indian thinkers posited primacy of the Vāk , the *Shabda*(word) in their conception about both inner and outer world. The Vāk is the creative force of the universe. In a way, they were absolutely right. The world is in flux. Nothing is at absolute rest. Each movement produces sound. Audible sound is merely the grossest manifestation. The Vāk evolves in multiple stages from Pashyanti, Madhyama and the audible Vaikhari in the grammarian’s conception. The tantric philosophers postulatd another stage of absolute unity of all sound at the stage of Para Vāk. The sages observed internal sounds while closing the apertures in bodies like nostrils, ears,

eyes, mouth and discovered the nature and place of their origin. The nada with primordial vibration and a priori to the audible sound is seen as the path towards the Godhead of Para Vāk. The nada corresponds with the ether(Ākāśa) element among the five Mahābhūta. This is the vibration of the emptiness. Any phoneme gets charged with a bindu, which tantriks view as fusion of Siva and Shakti- the spanda principle. The bindu takes half the time taken in uttering a phoneme. But, bindu also tapers into subtler sound of nada which is equivalent to $1/16^{\text{th}}$ of a phoneme. The division of sound ends at the level of unmana which correspond to $1/512^{\text{th}}$ of the time taken to utter a phoneme(matra).

Since touch (sparsh) always produce sound, the sages developed a paradigm for phonemic emanation. The vowels(bīja) are equated with the Shiva and consonants(yoni) with the Shakti. Vowels are bīja since no compound word can be formed. The world evolves from phonemic emanation through merely grosser condensation of sound and created through three powers of iccha(desire), kriya(action) and jnana(wisdom). The great Kashmiri philosopher-mystic Abhinavagupta gave a meticulous schemata of the phonemic emanation in his work, *Tantrasara* and *Parātrīśikāvivaraṇa*. In the ether(Ākāśa), the mirror principle(bimba) operates. The first letter that emerged due to the inherent power of *Svātantrya* (freedom) from the Prakash(Shiva) is the vowel ‘a’ (अ). This is the anuttara.

When a, saw its reflection, it was filled with joy and ‘aa’ (आ) emerged. It desired for more and the third vowel ‘e’ (इ) emerged. This inheres the iccha shakti. Similarly u emerged with the inherent power of kriya shakti. Now, the first three short vowels have Sun-principle and their corresponding longer vowels has Soma(lunar) principle, as the latter three are the resting ground for the former three short vowels. When anuttara and *ananda* vowels fuse through *samghatta*(friction), ae, ai, ao, au emanates. These correspond to kriya shakti. When kriyashakti dissipates, all the vowels enter back into anuttara as a bindu and forms the vowel ang अ. The anuttara dissipates(visarga) into bindu and the sixteenth vowel अः (ah) ends the vowel cycle. While the anusvara(.) as the bindu represents the unity of Shiva and Shakti, the visarga represented as two dots(:) signify the division of the ultimate consciousness into two, Shiva and Shakti. This starts the emanation of the manifest universe in the form of consonants(vyanjana).

The consonants evolve in a pattern from guttural(kantha) to labials(osthya). These are the five series of five alphabets each forming a separate group of sparsha vyanjana. These 25 consonants also represent the 25 realities (tattvas) of the Samkhya philosophy. The five letters of *kavarga*(क = ka, ख = Ka/kha,

ग = ga, घ = Ga/gha, ङ = n`ga) represent the five mahābhūta- earth(prithvi), water(jala), fire(agni), wind(vayu) and space(Ākāśa), respectively. The next series of five alphabets, *chavarga*, stands for five tanmatras of smell(gandha), taste(rasa), sight(rupa), touch(sparsha) and hearing(shabda). The next pentad of *tavarga* corresponds with five instruments of action (karmendriya), thence comes the series corresponding with cognitive

instruments(*jnanendriya*) and the last one forms the series for *purusha*, *prakriti*, *buddhis* , *ahamkara* and *manas*. Even within a series, the letters are arranged according to condensation. The fifth element in the series corresponds to the ether(*akasha*) element and the first one with earth(*prithvi*) element. Therefore, all five series ends with nasal sound of *ng*, *na*, *ma* etc. and termed as *anunasikas*. There is another structural resemblance among all five series. The first and second letter in the series forms a pair. The third and forth forms another pair. The last one , the space element , is the nasalized form of the third one.

One can find another pattern that how *sparsha* consonants gets subtler and subtler as it emanates both laterally and vertically. The last *sparsh* consonant is *Ma* and here ends the manifest universe of touch(*sparsh*). By employing Panini's *pratyahara* technique, the combination of the first *sparsha* consonant *ka*(क) and the last *ma*(म), forms the word, *kama*(काम). The touch produces the *ananda* . The addition of *aa*(|) vowel forms the word, *Kama* meaning thereby the desire for touch in the material universe. It is this word which lies at the heart of *Srichakra* centre as *Kamakala* or the primordial desire , the primal seed of mind.

Next series of consonants is *Antahsth* (अन्तःस्थ) comprised of the semivowels of the *yavarga* series. Here the order of materiality is reversed. *La* is the *prithvi* element and thence comes the three alphabets of *va*(water/*jala* element), *ra*(fire/*agni* element) and *ya*(wind/ *vayu* element). The alphabets from *ya* to *va* correspond too *raga*, *vidya*, *kala* and *maya* respectively. The last series of fricatives (*Uṣhm*) are produced by the friction(*samghatta*). After the three *sa* (स , श, ष), the *ha*(ह) is the *visarga*. Here the emanation of consonants ends. *Ha* is akin to two vowel *visargas* of *aa*(आ) and *ah*(अः) . These three kinds of *visarga* produce *ananda*. In *visarga*, the *matrika* rests(*vishram*). *Ha* has space(*akash*) element and this conjoins with the *yavarga* series to complete the pentad of letters.

Three *sa*(श, ष, स) correspond to *shuddha vidya* , *ishwar* and *sadashiva* in *Abhinavagupta*'s scheme. Apart from eight series, there is the ninth series that comprises a single compound letter - *ksha* (क्ष). This is formed by conjunction of two consonants- *ka*(क), the first consonant and *shh* (ष) , the last consonant. By employing *pratyahara* technique, *ksha* is the manifestation of all the consonants from *ka* to *shh* or the world of manifestation. *Ksha* is the *samyakakshara*. The seed syllables of the mantras are derived from the proper understanding of the *matrika*.

Finally, the sages pinned the source of life unto *prana*. Breath is the carrier of *prana*. The sound of breath was observed to open up a simple path to the *ParaVāk*. The sound of inhalation and exhalation as 'sa' and 'ha' respectively unlocked the secret of this phonemic path. While sages of *Upanishads* eulogized the combination of two letters along with the

nasal “ng” , as the Hamsa(हंस) or the swan of wisdom and its anadrome as the Soham (सोहम्) or ‘I am that’ postulating the non-duality between jiva and the Brahman, individual and the cosmos. The tantras also harped upon the conception of prana shakti circulating through the mechanism of ‘sa’ and ‘ha’ sound. *Sa* is the srishti bīja and *ha* is the samhara bīja. *Sa* represents the state of manifested universe where balance and harmony is established. This is also known as the amrita bīja (the seed for elixir). From *sa*, is derived words like sudha, sundar, santushti, sam. In *ha*, the manifest phonemic universe finally dissolves. This is the ultimate visarga. Hence *ha* is the seed of dissolution. *Sa* is the jiva, then *ha* is the Shiva, the ultimate destroyer. The inhalation and exhalation cycle produces the continuous sound of soham/hamsa or Jiva is Shiva, Thou am I. Śrī Vidya conceptualized a sequence of the aksharas employing these seed syllables as the powerful Śrīmantra.

The panchadashi mantra (15-lettered) has been revealed by Śrī Shankaracharya in the 32nd Verse of the Saundaryalahari:

क ए ई ल हीं

ka – e – ī – la - hrīm

ह स क ह ल हीं

ha - sa – ka – ha - la - hrīm

स क ल हीं

sa – ka - la - hrīm

The mantra has 3 kutas, first being Vagbhava, second is the Kamaraja and the last one is the Shakti kuta. These kutas correspond with the process of dissolution, maintenance and creation. Since the phoneme ए, represents the knowledge principle, the Vagbhava kuta has predominance of subtle intellect and stands for the MahaSaraswati, the Goddess of wisdom. The second kuta has first letter *sa* meaning thereby wealth, and *ka* for women and other object of desire(Kama) and *ha* is to go or attainment of these. According to Bhaskara Raya’s *Varivasya –Rahasya* , the second kuta has preponderance of valour, wealth, women and fame and hence the Kamaraj Kuta also signify Mahalakshmi. The third kuta does not have any vowel or the letter *ha* (Shiva), hence it is known as the Shakti Kuta and signifies Mahakali. The seed syllable *hrim* (*hrileka*) is attached in all three kutas . *Hrim* is derived from the root “Hr” that signifies destruction of the entire universe. *Ha* is akash, and *ra* is the fire principle. *Ra* is the kalanal or the kalagni which destroys the time(kala). The “i” is the kamakala , Vama lochana, *Hrim* is mayabija. In fact, it is the fusion of Shiva and Shakti principle. A subtle nada emanates when letter *r* and *I* are pronounced along with the bindu and its navanad. *Hrim* is also known as the *navanad* in Lalita Sahastranama (70.300) :

Narayani nadarupa namarupa vivarjita

Hrinkari hrimati hrudya heyopadeyavarjita – 70

The nine nadas has been explained in the **Varivasya Rahasya** beginning from bindu(m) as the ardha-chandra, rodhini, nada, nadanta, sakti, vyapika, sa-mana and Un-mani. Thus, it is seen how number nine emerges as the predominant number in the cosmogony and other formulations of Śrīvidya. Three kutas also represent three fires of kalanal, sun and the moon respectively. The first kuta begins from the Muladhar and touches anahata, the second kuta extends with brilliance of the sun from anahat to Ajna-chakra and the third kuta touches the Lalata-madhya(middle of the forehead) from the Ajna-chakra. Thus a homologous relationship is drawn between the subtle chakras within human body and the three kutas of the mantra.

The *Varivasya Rahasya* explains the first kuta in following ways(verse 60,61): Kakara(*ka*) signifies kamesvara, i.e. one who desires and here it is the Brahman; the second letter (*E*), signifies the genital organ as it is triangular in shape, the third letter is Shiva who is immanent and all-sustaining. Lakara (*La*) signifies the earth and hrim is the maya. In the second kuta, “*ha sa ka*” means smiling face since *ka* signifies the face and *hasa* is hasya or laughter. The other half of the second kuta is *ka ha la*. *Ka* is also the sun and *ha* is the moon. *La* is the eye. One which has sun and the moon as eyes is the “*ka ha la*”. The second kuta would mean that the Brahman is bliss and supreme consciousness with its cidrupa. (*Varivasya Rahasya*, verse 137-139). The third verse “*sa ka la*” refers to jiva as the jiva has three states of consciousness- jagrat, , svapna and susupti. Hrim is the Shakti-bija. Therefore, the third kuta will imply that all is Brahman. This is the Maha-vakyartha as per Bhaskara Raya (*Varivasya Rahasya*, verse 143-147).

The same text mentions about 16 different meaning of the Śrīvidya. In the Sama-rasy-artha of the Vidya, the meaning of three kutas is that Brahman is Siva and is also Sakti, since the concordance exists between Siva and Sakti (*Varivara Rahasya*, verse 120). There are three pairs of alphabets in the mantra if one counts the hrim syllable as the mere appendix. While *ka* and *ha* are the Siva principles, *La* and *Sa* are the shakti principle. The two vowels ate shaktis. Hrilekha itself is the Para-Brahman as Shiva in form of *ha* and Shakti in form of *ra* fuse and vibrates unto the navanad of hrimkari shakti. Another interpretation of panchadashi mantra is to connect the five Shakti triangles(downward) which constitute Śrīyantra with the form of the five elements (bhūta). These bhūta have a total of 15 qualities – earth element has five qualities of smell, taste, sight, touch, sound; water element has other four except the quality of smell; fire element has three except the quality of smell and taste; wind element has only touch and sound, and space element has only sound/sabda. . These fifteen division(kala) transforms into time factors and known as tithi(days) which wax or wane along with the moon and are in fact digits of the moon. The fifteen nityas form the 15 lettered mantra which is the sound body of the Goddess Lalita of Śrī Vidya. But, it is the sixteenth digit of the Moon, which is verily the Moon. This Ṣoḍaśī syllable is very secret and not shared beyond the kula.

New Revelations of Import of Mantra

While contemplating over the mantra for many months, sudden flash pieced me while I was moving underground in a tube train in Delhi. Three kutas(Trikuta) have a common pattern. The hrīmkari (*hrīṁ*) is preceded by the earth element(prithvi tattva), La in phonetic correspondence. Once we separate La and *hrīṁ*, only nine letters are left, three in the first kuta, 4 in second kuta and 2 in the third kuta. This is a nine-fold code hidden beneath the 15-lettered panchadashi. We have already seen how *hrīṁ* itself is nine-folded sound, navanad.

If one infers meaning from the combination of *La*(prithvi bīja) and *hrīṁ* (*maya* bīja), this should exude following meaning: From the earth (La) to the akash(ha), the maya bīja pervades.

But what is this maya bīja? *Ha* is the ultimate visarga of the phonemic emanation. *Ha* is the akash principle. When the universe dissolves, each grosser element dissolves into its succeeding subtler element. All bhūta finally dissolve into akash represented by *ha*, the last consonant. *Ra* is the *rahu* that swallows the akash. *Hr.* is the dissolution of the manifest universe which is nothing but merely illusion(*maya*). But the same seed also contains the power of creation in the form of ee(ई) topped with spandana power of bindu. Thus, in each dissolution, seed of creation remain intact and the cyclic movement goes on. *Hrīṁ* is also known as hrilekha as it is the condensed potency of Shakti. Only this can express itself in new creation.

With the new interpretation, we can decipher the elegant wisdom in the panchadashi mantra of Śrīvidya. In the first kuta क ए ई ल ह्रीं, former three phonemes represent the primordial powers of will, knowledge and action(iccha shakti from kamraj bīja Ka क, jnanashakti from bīja Ae ए and kriyashakti from bīja ee ई). The meaning of the kuta will be as follow: The three powers of will, knowledge and action pervade from the earth to space and also dissolves illusions(maya). In the second kuta ह स क ह ल ह्रीं, hasa

(ह स) is for hasya, laughter or joy principle (ananda). This ananda pervades from *ka* to *ha* or across the manifest universe of the consonants(*ka* to *ha*) and end the illusion of maya. In the third kuta स क ल ह्रीं, *sa* is the jiva and *ka* is the Shiva. The verse will mean thereby that there is absolute non-duality between jiva and Shiva, microcosm and macrocosm, individual and cosmos, immanence and transcendence. Realization of this non-duality dissolves illusion.

Though, the 16th letter is secret and esoteric, the single phoneme appened with bindu and ee shakti, will be the fourth or the turiya stage of the shodash Śrīvidya mantra.

Nine-fold pattern in the Human Perspective

There are various other nine-fold characterizations. The three Shaktis, having the three gunas and with three fire as her three eyes, compose of nine aspect is the *Graha-*

rupa(assuming the form of the nine planets) (*Varivasya Rahasya*, Verse 84). Time is divided into nine parts ranging from *ghatika*(24 minute-interval) to *abda*(year). Body is island of nine gems as per *Bhavanopanishad*(verse 6-8) comprising of *tvak*(touch), *roma*(hair) and seven *dhatus*. There are nine planets. Body has nine orifices. Interestingly, the human foetus grows in womb for nine months. Probably, the human being which grows under the constraint of *nonaness* with the power of consciousness explores nine-folded patterns in external and internal world. Indian sages have factorized alphabets into nine series with *ksha* (क्ष) as the last letter summing up all the 50 alphabets. Corresponding to these 51 letters are 51 shakti-pithas in Indian geobody spread across the sub-continent which creates an idea of common cultural space. *Śrī*yantra which generates 43 triangles through three levels of furcation caused by intersection of nine triangles has been held in awe by the sages and mystics across the religious spectrum in the sub-continent. The *Śrī*vidya mantra and yantra has developed the most elaborate method to connect time and space in a nested hierarchy in an abstract diagram and code sequence. The methodical system reveals to a sadhak how ultimately the whole universe throbs with the three powers of will, knowledge and action, and crave for more and more ananda and in the process attains unity of things. This scheme highlights the interrelationality of each element to every other element and how the division (*kala*) and fusion, creation and dissolution, potency and manifestation goes side by side in the cosmos.

The powerful seed syllable *shring* (श्री) in the *Ṣoḍaśakshari* is derived from the word *Shring*. This corresponds with the sixteenth digit of the moon also known as the digit of immortality. It is this connection of number sixteen with the eternal power of renewal that the culture of sixteen festivals, sixteen kind of *shringar*, sixteen *kalas* of proficiency and so on became popular in Indian culture. *Shring* denotes two horns. *Shringa* is also the mountain peak. In Buddhist and Brahmanical philosophy, the concept of horned rabbit as an example of non-existent thing was often mentioned. *Śrī*vidya is like the horn of all other spiritual practises. It is the highest peak of *sadhna* which also makes us to realize the fusion of existence and non-existence; creation and dissolution symbolized in the seed syllable of *Hrīm*. In Indian mythology, *Yama*, the god of death is represented with two horns. *Śrī*vidya with its own hidden seed-sound of *shring* (श्री) is the antidote against the fear of horned *Yama*. The mantra is the ultimate code to further decipher the cosmic inter-relationality. *Śrī* Ramakrishna himself was a great adept in this science after his initiation by the great Mother *Bhairavi*. This allowed him to taste the bliss of various spiritual path. He attained the *advaita* awareness and could declare boldly “*Jiva is Shiva*”.

References:

1. *Varivasya –Rahasya of Sri Bhaskara-Raya Makhin with his own commentary “Prakasha”*, ed. with English translation by Pandit S. Subrahmanya Sastri, the Adyar Library, Adyer, 1948.



Image: Padma
Shankara

Taste of Wholeness from the Great Empty and other Poems

Dr. Ambika Talwar



My arms rise to sky in longing...
Drum me into fullness.

This chilling autumn sweeps
fallen ground poked with frost.

Such brilliance that my heart
 weeps with fire for thee as I

rise ever taller — stretching bowing
 pine peers into your faraway face.

Yes, we are surrounded by fluted
 October colors: Where are you? You...

drummer to drum me into thee
 brilliance of bliss is this...just this..!

Does it all end in searching, or shall
 we be found in veins of fallen leaves

this autumn plum-orange-brown
 skinned for feast of immortality?

Drum me into fullness a rich song,
 sing this: why are you not here?

I taste the sound of each beat as
 my heart sweeps wild empty spaces.

In fire in frost we melt we burn —
 What kind of love is this?

That we wait to ascend into
 Great Empty to be whole...!
 The Open Door

One half of bridge emerges
 on the other side of Cloud River.
 It's hard to see for the golden-blue shades
 contain the fading light...

Maybe the bridge is inner light...

Someone turns it on: Someone's knocking
on the roof. A dream comes
to peel away noise from the music.

It isn't breath that makes one immortal
but breathlessness: what death's dying
does to us when we cross that bridge;
Wash our feet skin bones in rivers
too fast to understand or hold in our arms.
Sometimes life is like that: too fast
to hold in our arms. So we pass on beyond
the bridge, hope to land on the steps

of the yonder bridge. I wouldn't like to fall
in space of clouds. I'd shut my eyes,
be swallowed by the river that runs away.
Am I in hounds of silence? Or in heaven?

Golden-blue hues color my windows.
The clarity of my eyes sees through
my living my dying my arriving as I ascend
a staircase to the open door. Shall I enter?

A Vanishing Point

Woman on fire—ineffably on fire
fired in clay pit
inevitably arrives
glossed and brushed.

Thusly, my imaginal selves
remember forgotten tastes;
veil of fog lifts a hem
reveals possibilities unnamed.

Yes, Beloved.

We wander through
bitter-sweet blood
orange orchards where

trees sing with embers' glow;
here fire cools under the soot
where stories have lain.

Such is the quickening memory
twice born three times
in crimson red sun—

Those are your eyes.

Your rubies fall into my lap
like love I welcome...

Brightly my ambers embrace you.
We are on fire even as
sapphires dangle from sky;
I am held captive in your eyes,
I have swum in your longing.

Familiar songs awake my feet,
those finely chiseled feet
aching for resolutions...

All my life they have ached
my breaking feet making whole
the earth where I walk;

Lives are not wasted,
tho' it feels this way.

After a life, comes
this celebration:

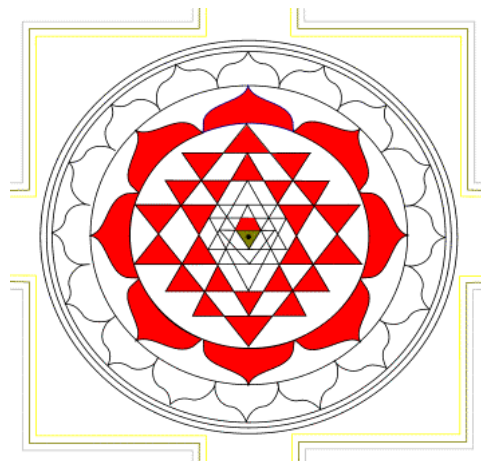
Now answers need no questions.
 Edge of darkness shifts lifting
 hem of Gaia's unending ridges.

Our eyes glow, tongues intone,
 sacred kiss quenches pale
 yellow sky into acquiescence.

We are anointed with a hymnal
 so sacrosanct
 that gods part cosmos
 to be witness:

Perfect vision of garden
 delights our silent gaze;
 tears become pearls.

Greatest dream arises
 like Venus flowing in fabric
 of emerald azure seas...
 We are a vanishing point.



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